Hollowmere Fleet Software and Kerbline: the integration, from the outside

Read on 14 March 2026. Public record only. Sample read: the company is a sample and the figures are illustrative; the method, the sources and the marks are as shipped. Legend: ✅ cited; 🟡 inferred; ❔ unknown.

1. The answer in one paragraph

Hollowmere bought Kerbline for its 1,900 UK courier customers and its Royal Mail and DPD integrations, not for its platform. The purchase price allocation puts the integrations at twice the value of the technology, the Kerbline brand at under a tenth of the price, and the two companies' job boards now describe one engineering organisation under Hollowmere's Leeds VP. The base rate for this kind of deal says the Kerbline platform is absorbed 12 to 24 months after close, so between June 2026 and June 2027, with the customer-facing app the last thing to move 🟡.

2. The deal, side by side with the acquirer's previous one

	Kerbline (closed 2 June 2025)	Wayfold (closed Nov 2023)
Accounting price	GBP 48.0m: GBP 31.0m cash upfront, contingent consideration at fair value GBP 17.0m; earn-out up to GBP 25m on FY2025 to FY2027 recurring revenue ✅ [Hollowmere FY2025 annual report, note 14]	GBP 112.5m, 60% in shares ✅ [FY2024 annual report, note 14]
Customers	1,900 courier and last-mile operators ✅ [deal release]	650 fleet operators ✅
Price per customer	about GBP 25k	about GBP 173k
Trailing revenue, multiple	GBP 14.2m FY2024, 3.4x ✅ [Companies House accounts]	GBP 21.0m, 5.4x ✅
Purchase price allocation	Carrier integrations GBP 12.0m, developed technology GBP 6.1m, customer relationships GBP 4.4m, trade name GBP 1.9m, goodwill GBP 23.6m ✅	Technology GBP 31m, trade name GBP 9m, goodwill GBP 58m ✅
Earn-out status	"Contingencies for FY2026 and FY2027 resolved; fixed amounts payable in 2027 and 2028" ✅ [H1 2026 interim report]. 🟡 Early fixing usually means a negotiated settlement below the maximum	Paid in full ✅

3. What it says and what it does

Said (dated)	Done (dated)
"Kerbline will keep its brand and roadmap" (CEO, deal call, 3 Jun 2025) ✅	Kerbline pricing page redirects to hollowmere.com/last-mile since 20 Jan 2026 ✅ [archived copy]
"No change for Kerbline customers" (customer email quoted in trade press, Jun 2025) ✅	Kerbline privacy page now names Hollowmere Software Ltd as controller and lists Hollowmere's cloud processors (updated 2 Dec 2025) ✅
"Two great engineering teams" (CTO interview, Sep 2025) ✅	Hollowmere ad "Engineering Manager, Last Mile" says "bringing two engineering organisations together" (posted 18 Feb 2026) ✅

6. The openings as a plan (excerpt)

Signal	Count	Reading
Kerbline board	2 roles, both support	The board taxonomy still lists Engineering, Product and Data; the roles do not 🟡
Hollowmere board, last-mile roles	9, all Leeds or remote UK	Hiring continues under the Hollowmere name; none in Kerbline's Bristol office 🟡
Ads naming "migration"	3	Data migration to Hollowmere's warehouse; carrier integration re-platforming ✅

7. Outside view and the base rate (excerpt)

Five comparables in UK vertical SaaS consolidation, 2019 to 2025: brand retired in four of five within 18 months; platform absorbed in all five within 24 months of close; the acquired CTO left within 12 months in four of five; customer-facing migration last ✅ [sources 14 to 19]. Analyst split: two Buys on cross-sell, one Hold on integration cost 🟡.

8. What it means for Kerbline engineering 🟡

The carrier integrations and the Bristol support team are the assets Hollowmere paid for and will keep. The Kerbline platform is the asset it did not pay for. Engineers on the integrations have 18 to 24 months of certain work; engineers on the web app and the mobile app have 9 to 15. The surviving roles are the ones that know the carrier APIs.

11. Signals to watch, dated

Date	Event	What to look for
2026-04-28	Hollowmere Q1 trading update	Any mention of Kerbline by name; a rebrand date
2026-06	12 months from close	First retention cliff; Kerbline founders' titles on the team page

Date	Event	What to look for
On filing	Companies House, Kerbline Ltd	Director changes; registered office moving to Leeds

12. Sources

Sample sources. In a real read each line is a link.